

10-Day Pre-Launch Strategy for Velaris: A Research-Backed Playbook

An AI Visibility Platform launching January 15th with no existing audience faces a compressed timeline but can achieve **25-150 signups** through a strategic blend of behavioral science principles, LinkedIn-first organic content, and surgical paid amplification. The key insight: founder-led content on LinkedIn combined with a well-executed Product Hunt launch represents the highest-ROI path for a B2B SaaS targeting marketers and agencies.

This report synthesizes evidence from behavioral economics research, seven detailed SaaS launch case studies (including Lemlist, Superhuman, Notion, and Loom), current LinkedIn algorithm data, and platform-specific tactics to provide a day-by-day execution plan for two commitment levels.

The psychology that drives successful launches

Behavioral science provides the architecture for your 10-day sprint. Research from Cialdini and Kahneman reveals specific psychological levers that increase conversions by **27-270%** when properly applied.

Loss aversion outperforms gain framing by 50% in conversion testing. (Getmonetizely) Rather than saying "Get early access to Velaris," frame messaging as "Don't lose your founding member pricing—increases 40% after launch." Kahneman's research shows losses feel psychologically twice as powerful as equivalent gains. Apply this to countdown content starting Day 7.

Social proof increases conversions by 270% (Genesysgrowth) according to Spiegel Research Center. Even with no existing customers, you can manufacture social proof through beta tester feedback, waitlist counts ("Join 247 marketers already on the list"), and expert endorsements. Testimonials on sales pages increase conversions by **34%**, with video testimonials delivering an **80%** lift over text.

The curiosity gap sustains engagement across your content arc. Movie studios begin building anticipation 120 days before release through carefully orchestrated reveals. Compress this into 10 days by opening loops in early content that you close later—each post answers one question while raising another.

Micro-commitments create psychological investment. The foot-in-the-door technique (Freedman & Fraser, 1966) shows that someone agreeing to a small request becomes more likely to agree to larger ones. Structure your campaign as escalating commitments: Day 1 email signup → Day 5 survey completion → Day 8 share with a colleague → Day 10 purchase decision.

What seven SaaS case studies reveal about building from scratch

Lemlist's \$1,000 to \$40M journey maps directly to your situation

Guillaume Moubeche started Lemlist with **\$1,000** (Growthunhinged) and no audience in 2018. By 2024, the company reached **\$40M ARR** while remaining bootstrapped. The primary growth engine: LinkedIn personal branding.

Moubeche built a 500,000+ follower LinkedIn audience by posting actionable sales tips daily. He then created an internal course training his entire team to build personal brands, collectively generating **20M+ LinkedIn impressions monthly**. The lesson: your founder's LinkedIn presence is your most valuable organic channel.

Their tactical sequence mirrors what works for a 10-day sprint:

- Product Hunt launch for initial validation (#1 product of the day)
- AppSumo lifetime deal generated \$160K in two weeks (even keeping only \$50K after cuts)
- Community building through a 90,000-member Facebook group
- Transparent "building in public" content documenting wins and failures

Superhuman's waitlist psychology offers a template for exclusivity

Superhuman built a **500,000+ person waitlist** for a \$30/month email client by making users "request access" rather than sign up. They would actually deny access if user needs didn't match features. This manufactured scarcity created aspirational demand.

However, their data reveals a crucial insight: **waitlist conversion was 3x lower** than live funnel conversion (3% vs 10%). For a 10-day sprint without time to build waitlist momentum, consider offering immediate early access rather than a waitlist.

Loom's Product Hunt mastery shows the power of personalized engagement

Loom's co-founders recorded **personalized video responses** to every Product Hunt comment during their launch—creating immediate viral engagement. Day 1: 3,000 signups. Within 100 days: 12,800+ users. Eventually: \$975M acquisition.

The transferable tactic: respond to every comment on launch day with personalized, thoughtful replies. This signals quality to the algorithm and builds genuine relationships.

Taplio's free tool strategy drives 70% of organic traffic

Taplio built free tools—LinkedIn Headline Generator, Video Downloader, Summary Generator—that capture email addresses while providing genuine value. A single free tool page captures **70% of their organic traffic**.

(X) Consider creating one valuable free tool related to AI visibility (even a simple calculator or checker) as your lead magnet.

LinkedIn strategy: Your highest-leverage organic channel

LinkedIn's algorithm in 2025 heavily favors personal profiles over company pages. Company page organic reach has collapsed to just **2% of users' feeds**, (authoredup) while personal profiles can achieve **20-30% reach** with engaged followers. This makes founder-led content your primary organic strategy.

Algorithm mechanics that matter for launch content

Content moves through three stages: initial classification (0-60 minutes), engagement testing (1-2 hours), and extended distribution (2+ hours). [authoredup](#) **The first hour is critical**—posts gaining strong engagement can remain visible for 2-3 weeks rather than the previous 24-48 hours. [Hootsuite Blog](#)

Engagement signals rank in this order of algorithmic weight:

- **Saves** (5x more reach than likes—the strongest trust signal) [authoredup](#)
- **Meaningful comments** (10+ words carry 2x the weight of likes)
- **Indirect comments** (replies to other comments increase reach by 2.4x) [authoredup](#)
- **Dwell time** (longer reading signals valuable content)
- **Reposts with commentary** (5-10% additional reach)

Posting specifications for maximum distribution

Optimal times for B2B audiences: Tuesday-Thursday between 8:00-11:00 AM, with Wednesday at 10:00 AM showing highest engagement. Avoid weekends (lowest engagement) and Monday mornings (catch-up mode).

Frequency: Post once daily, never more than once per 12 hours. Multiple posts cannibalize each other's reach.

[Botdog](#) Weekly posting consistency leads to **2x engagement lift** according to LinkedIn data. [hootsuite](#)

Format performance (2025 data):

Format	Reach Multiplier
Polls	1.64x
Documents/Carousels	1.45x
Images	1.18x
Video	1.10x
Text-only	0.88x

Post length: 800-1,000 characters for most posts, maximum 4 lines per paragraph. Write at a 4th-grade reading level—10th+ grade content sees **35% less reach**. [authoredup](#)

Building from zero requires aggressive commenting

When starting with no audience, follow the **90/10 rule**: spend 90% of time engaging on others' content, 10% creating. [Shield Analytics](#) A proven framework:

- **70%** on influencer posts (50k+ followers) for visibility
- **20%** on target prospect posts for relationship building

- **10%** on strategic posts that open conversations

Comment within **10-15 minutes** of posts going live for maximum visibility. Write 10+ words minimum—short comments carry less algorithmic weight. (Louise Brogan) One B2B consultant using this strategy saw **220% increase in profile views**, 57 inbound leads, and 11 new clients in 60 days.

The 10-day content calendar: Day-by-day execution

This calendar assumes starting January 5th for a January 15th launch. Content types blend educational value (70-80%) with strategic promotional elements (10-15%) and story-driven engagement (10-20%).

Phase 1: Foundation and story (Days 1-3)

Day 1 (Jan 5) — "Why we built this" Primary content: Long-form LinkedIn post telling the origin story. Focus on the problem discovered—not the product yet. Frame: "For 3 years, I watched agencies lose visibility into their AI presence across platforms. Here's why we decided to build something different..."

Format: Text-based story post, 800-1,000 characters. End with a question inviting engagement.

Day 2 (Jan 6) — Pain point deep-dive Primary content: Carousel educating on the problem (not your solution). Example: "5 signs your agency is invisible to AI systems—and what it's costing you."

This uses the Problem-Agitate-Solution framework without the solution reveal. Agitate the consequences: lost leads, competitive disadvantage, client concerns about AI visibility.

Day 3 (Jan 7) — Behind-the-scenes journey Primary content: Authentic development content showing the messy reality. Screenshots of Slack conversations, whiteboard sessions, late-night coding. Frame: "Here's what the last 6 months actually looked like..."

This "building in public" approach has become "one of the best ways for tech companies to avoid issues of inauthenticity." (Ceros) Buffer, ConvertKit, and Webflow all built audiences this way—Webflow reached **\$2B valuation** partly through transparent journey-sharing. (Upsilon)

Phase 2: Value and validation (Days 4-6)

Day 4 (Jan 8) — Pure educational value Primary content: Framework or methodology post with zero pitch. Example: "The 4-part framework we developed to audit AI visibility—use it today without any tools."

This establishes expertise while the 80/20 rule dictates: **80% value content, 20% promotional**. Educational content "performs better because it answers the questions people are actually asking." (Multiview)

Day 5 (Jan 9) — Social proof introduction Primary content: Beta tester feedback with real names and companies (with permission). Screenshot format performs well. Frame: "We showed this to 10 agency owners. Here's what they said..."

Even limited social proof matters: products with **4.2-4.5 star ratings** show optimal purchase likelihood—perfection (5.0) is less trusted than authenticity.

Day 6 (Jan 10) — Feature teaser Primary content: Short video or GIF showing one compelling feature. Don't reveal everything—maintain the curiosity gap. Frame: "Sneak peek at one feature that's going to change how you monitor AI visibility..."

Optimal LinkedIn video length: **30 seconds**. Use captions—72% of users browse on mobile.

Phase 3: Build momentum (Days 7-8)

Day 7 (Jan 11) — Interactive engagement Primary content: LinkedIn poll asking about pain points. Polls generate **1.64x reach multiplier**—the highest of any format. [authoredup](#)

Example poll: "What's your biggest challenge tracking AI visibility? A) Don't know where to start B) Too many platforms to monitor C) Can't prove ROI to clients D) Didn't know this was a problem"

Day 8 (Jan 12) — Countdown begins Primary content: "3 days until launch" announcement with countdown graphic. Introduce scarcity: "Founding member pricing available to first 100 signups."

Critical insight from research: "Be cautious not to tire your audience—start countdown posts during the remaining 3 days." [Prelaunch.com](#) [FasterCapital](#) Starting earlier risks fatigue. Countdown timers increase conversions by **30-50%** according to Poper research.

Reveal pricing anchor: Show future "regular" pricing first, then founding member discount. Example: "\$199/mo regular pricing, \$99/mo for founding members who join before January 20th."

Phase 4: Launch sequence (Days 9-10)

Day 9 (Jan 14) — Final countdown + value stack Primary content: Complete value proposition reveal. List all benefits (not features). Morning post: "Tomorrow changes everything." Afternoon post: testimonial compilation. Evening: personal founder note.

Multiple posts acceptable today as momentum builds. Maintain 7+ hours between posts.

Day 10 (Jan 15) — Launch day Execute a multi-post launch blitz:

- **6 AM:** Teaser — "Today's the day"
- **9 AM:** Main announcement from founder personal profile
- **12 PM:** Feature highlight video
- **3 PM:** Early user reaction
- **6 PM:** "Still time to get founding pricing" reminder

Coordinate team members (if applicable) to share perspectives staggered throughout day. Employee posts get **561% more reach** than brand page posts.

Organic versus paid: Where to invest limited budget

Reality check on organic-only outcomes

Starting from zero audience with 10 days, organic-only expectations are modest:

- **LinkedIn personal posts:** 100-500 impressions per post, potentially 1,000+ if content resonates
- **Product Hunt launch:** 50-300 signups if ranking top 10 (considered successful for B2B SaaS)
- **Total organic:** 20-100 signups if executed well

Organic reach has declined dramatically: Facebook business pages see **1.37-2.6% reach**, Instagram **4-7.6%**, LinkedIn company pages **2%**. Personal LinkedIn profiles remain the exception at 20-30% reach potential.

Budget allocation for maximum impact

For micro-budgets (\$100-500), this allocation optimizes for B2B SaaS targeting marketers:

Budget	Reddit Ads	LinkedIn	Newsletter	Retargeting	Expected Leads
\$100	\$60	\$40 boost	—	—	1-5
\$250	\$100	\$75 Lead Gen	\$75	—	5-10
\$500	\$150	\$175 Lead Gen	\$125	\$50	10-20

Reddit offers best cost efficiency for tech audiences with CPCs of **\$0.50-\$2.00** compared to LinkedIn's **\$5.58-\$10**. Target r/SaaS, r/marketing, r/Entrepreneur, r/startups.

LinkedIn Lead Gen Forms reduce cost-per-lead by **20-30%** versus sending traffic to landing pages because they eliminate friction. Use Thought Leader Ads (founder's personal posts as ads) for **0.95% CTR**—nearly 2x standard ad performance.

Sponsored newsletter placements offer highly targeted reach at \$50-250 for smaller newsletters. [Beehiiv](#)
Platforms like Paved and Swapstack connect advertisers with relevant newsletters.

LinkedIn ads targeting for marketers/agencies

Target these criteria:

- Job titles: Marketing Director, VP Marketing, CMO, Agency Owner, Digital Marketing Manager
- Company size: 50-500 employees (mid-market sweet spot)
- Industries: Marketing & Advertising, Technology
- Skills: Digital Marketing, Marketing Automation, Growth Marketing [HawkSEM](#)

Warning: Audiences under 50K artificially inflate costs.

PR and earned media: Leveraging platforms

Product Hunt execution timeline

Timing: Launch Tuesday, Wednesday, or Thursday at **12:01 AM Pacific Time** for full 24-hour window. (Tetriz)
Since January 2024, only ~10% of submitted products get featured on homepage—focus on mobilizing supporters rather than depending on organic discovery. (Tetriz)

Pre-launch requirements (should be started immediately):

- Create personal accounts (company accounts prohibited) (Product Hunt)
- Set up "Coming Soon" teaser page to collect supporters
- Prepare assets: 1270px × 760px images minimum, (Appcues) demo video, compelling one-sentence tagline
- Draft first comment (your founder story + ask for feedback)

Launch day tactics:

- Have supporter list ready to engage immediately
- Contact long-time Product Hunt users first (their votes may carry more weight)
- Don't send direct links—have supporters search for you (PH detects coordinated link clicks) (Tomdekan)
- Respond to every comment personally (Loom's founders recorded video responses to each)

Realistic expectations: Bottom of front page yields ~2,000 unique visitors; #1 spot yields ~10,000+. Goal: **1,000+ email captures** is reasonable.

Hacker News approach

Post format: "Show HN: Velaris — [What it does in one sentence]" (Lucasfcosta) (ycombinator) Best time: **Wednesday, 8-9 AM Eastern** (Startup Grind)

HN requires different positioning than Product Hunt. Remove marketing language entirely—speak as fellow builders. (Indie Hackers) Make the product tryable without signup. One-click demo preferred.

Success story metrics: 13 hours on front page → 11k visitors → 300+ signups → 2x MRR → Domain Rating +12 overnight. (Indie Hackers)

HN is random—luck matters significantly. If your post doesn't gain traction but deserves attention, email hn@ycombinator.com for the "second-chance pool." (Indie Hackers)

Reddit strategy (long-term setup required)

Reddit requires authentic community participation over months before promotional activity. (Single Grain) For a 10-day sprint, focus on:

- Participating genuinely in r/SaaS, r/marketing, r/Entrepreneur discussions
- Sharing insights without product mentions
- Using Reddit Ads (\$0.50-\$2 CPC) rather than organic promotion

The 80/20 rule applies strictly: 80% pure community value, 20% can mention your work. Single Grain New accounts promoting products face immediate credibility destruction.

Two commitment scenarios: Full versus middle

Full commitment (2-3 hours daily)

This scenario maximizes all available channels and produces the highest probability of 100+ launch signups.

Daily breakdown:

- **Content creation:** 45-60 minutes (one primary post, Stories, secondary content)
- **Engagement/commenting:** 60 minutes (critical for algorithm and relationship building)
- **Outreach/DMs:** 30-45 minutes (personalized connections, journalist/podcast outreach)
- **Platform management:** 30 minutes (Product Hunt prep, responding to comments)

Full commitment priorities by day:

Day	Primary Focus	Secondary Focus
1-3	Story content + PH setup	50+ strategic LinkedIn comments daily
4-6	Value content + beta outreach	Newsletter sponsorship booking
7-8	Countdown + paid ads launch	Press/podcast pitching
9-10	Launch blitz	All-channel engagement

Channel activation:

- LinkedIn: Daily posting + aggressive commenting
- Product Hunt: Full launch execution
- Hacker News: Show HN post on launch day
- Reddit Ads: \$100-200 campaign targeting tech subreddits
- LinkedIn Ads: \$100-200 Thought Leader campaign
- One newsletter sponsorship: \$75-150

- Press: 10-20 personalized journalist pitches
- Podcast: 5-10 outreach emails for future guesting

Expected outcomes (full commitment + \$300-500 budget):

- 5,000-15,000 total impressions
- 100-300 website visitors
- 50-150 signups
- 5-15 qualified leads

Middle commitment (30-60 minutes daily)

This scenario focuses exclusively on highest-ROI activities, accepting reduced reach for sustainable execution.

Daily breakdown:

- **Content creation:** 20-30 minutes (one LinkedIn post only)
- **Engagement:** 20-30 minutes (strategic commenting on 10-15 posts)
- **Minimal admin:** 10 minutes (responses, scheduling)

What to cut:

- Hacker News (requires significant time investment)
- Press outreach (relationship-building takes months)
- Reddit participation (not worth it without community history)
- Multiple platform posting (LinkedIn only)
- Newsletter sponsorships (added complexity)

What to keep:

- LinkedIn founder posts (your single highest-leverage activity)
- Strategic LinkedIn commenting (builds audience without content creation)
- Product Hunt launch (one-time effort with ongoing returns)
- Simple paid boost: \$100 Reddit Ads OR \$100 LinkedIn post boost (pick one)

Middle commitment priorities by day:

Day	Primary Focus	Time Allocation
1-4	LinkedIn posts + commenting	30-45 min
5-7	Content + PH prep	45-60 min
8-9	Countdown posts	30-45 min
10	Launch + PH	60-90 min

Expected outcomes (middle commitment + \$100 budget):

- 2,000-5,000 total impressions
- 50-100 website visitors
- 20-50 signups
- 2-5 qualified leads

Metrics to track throughout the sprint

Daily tracking (in a simple spreadsheet)

Content performance:

- Impressions per post
- Engagement rate (target: 2%+ for LinkedIn)
- Comments received
- Profile views (leading indicator of interest)

Conversion metrics:

- Website visitors (Google Analytics)
- Signup conversion rate (target: 2-5% visitor-to-signup)
- Email list growth
- Cost per signup (if running paid)

Launch day metrics

Product Hunt:

- Upvotes (top 5 = good visibility)

- Comments (engage with all)
- Traffic from PH (UTM tracking)
- Signups attributed to PH

Overall launch day:

- Total signups
- Traffic sources breakdown
- Engagement spike on LinkedIn
- Email open rates for launch announcement

Post-launch benchmarks

Compare against B2B SaaS benchmarks:

- Free trial-to-paid conversion: **15-25%** (industry average) Powered by Search
 - Demo request rate: **5-10%** of visitors
 - Cost per qualified lead: **\$50-200** (acceptable range)
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Conclusion: The asymmetric opportunity

The research reveals an asymmetric opportunity for B2B SaaS founders: **LinkedIn personal profiles remain underpriced** as an attention channel while company pages and traditional paid advertising face diminishing returns.

Three strategic insights emerge from this analysis:

First, founder-led content compounds while advertising depletes. Every LinkedIn post builds audience equity that persists beyond the campaign. Lemlist's Guillaume Moubeche built a \$40M ARR company primarily through 500,000 LinkedIn followers generating 20M+ monthly impressions—zero paid acquisition cost.

Second, behavioral science provides specific conversion multipliers. Loss-framed messaging delivers 50% higher conversion than gain-framed. Social proof increases conversions by 270%. Countdown timers add 30-50%. These aren't abstract principles—they're tactical levers with measured impact.

Third, Product Hunt remains the highest-ROI launch platform for B2B SaaS despite increased competition. A single day of focused execution can generate 2,000-10,000 website visitors and establish lasting social proof through the Product Hunt badge.

The 10-day constraint forces prioritization. For Velaris launching January 15th targeting marketers and agencies, the minimum viable strategy is: daily LinkedIn founder posts, aggressive strategic commenting, one

well-executed Product Hunt launch, and \$100-200 in Reddit or LinkedIn ads. Everything else—press, podcasts, Reddit organic, Hacker News—represents optimization, not requirements.

Start Day 1 content tomorrow. The clock is running.